

New Testament





About the Course

Students read through the book of Acts over the year. Additional study helps assigned in the lesson plans provide background information and context to help students begin to dive deeper into the life, ministry, and message of the early church.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the gospels. Ideal for HS students who are new to studying the Bible or unused to commentaries or discussions about cultural context or interpretive issues.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	New Testament: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition ESV Concise Study Bible Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grades 7-8



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



ESV Concise Study Bible



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Video overviews of Bible books from Bible Project](#)
- ∞ [Teaching the Bible with Dr. John Walton](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



New Testament: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.

Term 1

WEEK 1

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Intro to Acts

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook,

Note: Introducing the New Testament is a resource book that will be used over 5 years. As students get older, they will read more sections and interact with some of the more scholarly questions about the New Testament. Only small sections will be read this year, but feel free to read more.

→ INTRO

1. The book of Acts is actually "part two" of the Gospel of Luke, but it has been put in its own section in the New Testament (following the four Gospels) because it is the only book that relates the history of the early church—what happened after the events reported in the Gospels.
2. Watch this short video about Acts with the author of the book Introducing the New Testament.
∞ Video Link: Acts

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Materials: Introducing the New Testament p. 205-206 "The book of" - "Lord Jesus Christ."
2. In the video, the author asked you to pay attention to the key motifs that are outlined in the book of Acts. A motif is a dominant idea or central theme. Read about a couple of the motifs or major themes in Acts. p. 216-220 "The book of"-"is worth remembering."
3. Although Luke is the author of two books in the New Testament, he is only mentioned three times in the Bible by name.
Read the following verses to meet the author of the book of Acts: Col. 4:14; 2 Timothy 4:11; Philemon 24; Luke 1:1-1; Acts 1:1-5; Luke 24:36-53

→ NOTEBOOK

You read about five of the major themes in Acts. Write down each theme on the top line of 5 different pages in your notebook. Then write a brief sentence of what that theme means. As you read through Acts this year, you will add the events that fall under the different themes.

WEEK 2

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Ascension

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
Materials: Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 1:8 is the key verse of Acts, and the outline of Acts follows this verse as the gospel spreads and the church grows. Jesus gives the disciples a job after he leaves them on earth to ascend to heaven. "The ascension is the conclusion of the synoptic Gospels, and it is the introduction to Acts, where it begins the story of the development of the church." (Bible Story Handbook, Walton)

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Read about 3 more major theme in Acts p.220-223 "The Jewish matrix" - "of his name." (You can skip Box 10.5)
2. Acts 1:1-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the three additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. For example under the theme Centrality of Jerusalem, you can write "Jesus orders his disciples to not leave Jerusalem."

WEEK 3

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Pentecost

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the NT (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 2 is considered the church's birthday. Luke shows how the Holy Spirit came upon all the believers there, and how they begin speaking in other languages. This may bring to your mind the story from Genesis of the Tower of Babel. However, "[a]t the Tower of Babel, nobody could understand the languages and it drove people apart. At Pentecost, the languages could be understood and it brought people together into a unity that helped start the Church." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 2:1-41
 2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Study Bible.
- How does speaking different languages on the Day of Pentecost fit with Jesus' mission he gave

Term 1

the disciples in Acts 1:8?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. You can use Introducing the NT for extra guidance.

WEEK 4

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Unity

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
- Materials: Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The Holy Spirit had come on the Day of Pentecost, and the Christians were united, which led to the great expansion of the Church in the early days.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Read about two more major themes in Acts p.223-226 "As in the" - "to be offended." (Skip the boxes)
2. Acts 2:42-3:10
3. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the two additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 5

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Response to the Healing

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
- Materials: Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Read about one more major theme in Acts p.227-228 "The book of" - "like their master."
2. Acts 3:11-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the additional theme you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 6

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Brought Before Leadership

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the NT (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The healing of the lame man brought the attention of the Jewish leadership to the disciples. The Sadducees mentioned in the passage were "wealthy and politically connected Jews who had control of the temple personnel but were not themselves priests. One of the distinctive elements of their doctrine was the rejection of the resurrection." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 4
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible
 - The word "bold" or "boldness" is repeated in Acts 4. Why was boldness needed on the part of the disciples?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. You can use your book for guidance.

WEEK 7

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Ananias and Sapphira

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

Term 1

→ READ

1. Acts 4:32-37; Acts 5:1-42
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible
- How did the offering of Barnabas compare with the offering of Ananias and Sapphira?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Stephen is Introduced

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the book of Acts, Luke periodically gives a "progress report" of the early church. In verse 7, he gives a report that is glowing! But with all these additional people comes additional responsibilities that must be taken care of. Chapter 6 will show the movement into the second part of the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8 before he ascended into heaven, that of the gospel moving out from Jerusalem to "all Judea and Samaria."

→ READ AND NARRATE

1. Acts 6
2. (Optional) Read the notes on chapter 6 in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 9

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Stephen's Sermon

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Stephen is charged with blasphemy for speaking "against the law and the temple, both of which had attained a sacred status in Judaism. To speak disrespectfully about them was considered criminal. To suggest that the temple and the law were inadequate or would pass away was heresy. It was taken as strongly as someone today undermining democracy, freedom, or human rights... Stephen's speech showed his respect for...the law, the Tabernacle, and the temple...It was important for Luke to show that Stephen was executed based on false (unsubstantiated) accusations and his association with Jesus." (Bible Story Handbook) While the reports of the church's growth are tremendously encouraging, the story of Stephen's martyrdom showed the persecution the Christians faced and the anger with which the leadership viewed these new believers.

→ READ

1. Acts 7
2. (Optional) Read the notes in chapter 7 of the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 10

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Saul, Philip, Simon, & The Ethiopian Eunuch

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Through the end of Acts 7, Luke has described the preaching of the gospel in Jerusalem. It had been effective. Thousands had believed. In fact, others had flocked into the city to be with the apostles and experienced the healings that were taking place. Now, beginning with chapter 8, the gospel expands to Samaria, and Philip becomes the instrument of the first great missionary outreach.

→ READ

1. Acts 8
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 1

WEEK 11 **30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11**
Saul's Conversion

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP
What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO
Saul is brought back into the picture in chapter 9, with the story of his conversion. To the Jewish leaders, "the claim that Jesus is God was a major heresy and a threat to Judaism and had to be eliminated." (Bible Story Handbook) This is exactly what Saul's mission is at the opening of chapter 9. He wanted to persecute and eliminate the people of "The Way." Christians are called this a few times in the New Testament. Do you have an idea why? (Hint: John 14:6)

- READ AND NARRATE**
1. Acts 9:1-30
 2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What does Saul's testimony teach us about the character of God and who God is?

→ NOTEBOOK
Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 12 **30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12**
Exam week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Acts

Term 2

WEEK 1

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Peter and Cornelius

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The end of chapter 9 into chapter 10 focuses on Peter. Peter continues to minister, heal, and preach the gospel. In 9:31, Luke gives another progress report on the church. How does he define the early church's health and growth? In chapter 10, the story of Cornelius is a "key turning point in the book as the church is officially opened up to Gentiles." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

- Acts 9:31-10:48
- Chronological Guide to the Bible p.184 Sidebar: "Who Was the God-Fearing Cornelius?"

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 2

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Peter Tells Of His Vision

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

- Acts 11
- Read the notes for chapter 11 in the ESV Concise Study Bible
- Chronological Guide p.184 Sidebar: "Christians" in Antioch

→ NARRATE

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 3

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Peter Freed From Prison

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In this passage, King Herod is the grandson of Herod at the time of Jesus' birth. He was new to the throne, so "it is easy to see why this ruler...was interested in gaining favor with the ruling Jewish council." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

- Acts 12
- Read the notes for chapter 12 in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Paul Begins His First Missionary Journey

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

This week in Spiritual Formation, you will begin an in-depth study of Chapter 17 of Acts, which will accompany your reading in Transformed by Truth. As we continue to read Acts, we will gain a larger context for the book and the early church's growth, which helps when studying a specific verse or even a single word.

The focus switches from Peter to the Apostle Paul. It continues to follow the pattern of the key verse, Acts 1:8 as Paul and Barnabas begin a missionary journey that would take them approximately 1,400 miles between AD 46-48 (Bible Story Handbook). Having seen Barnabas' name a few times already in Acts, why do you think he would be a good choice as a missionary or one to tell the gospel message and encourage other believers?

Term 2

→ READ

1. Acts 13
2. Read the notes on chapter 13 in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

Paul will take three missionary journeys in Acts. You will create a diagram, chart or list in your notebook for each one. Today's reading begins his first journey. Make a list of the locations mentioned in chapter 13 and using the map in the ESV Concise Study Bible or the map on p.349 in the Ultimate Bible Atlas, trace the path of Paul and Barnabas. Write a short description of what happens in each place.

WEEK 5

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Paul and Barnabas Continue to Preach

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

1. Acts 14
2. Read Chronological Guide p.184 "The Gospel to the Gentile World"

→ NARRATE

Continue your chart or list of locations and include a short description of the events that happened at each location on Paul and Barnabas' first missionary journey. Use either the map in your ESV Concise Study Bible or the Ultimate Bible Atlas (p.349) to trace their route.

WEEK 6

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Jerusalem Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

1. Acts 15
2. Chronological Guide p.186 "Conference in Jerusalem"
3. Ultimate Bible Atlas p.344 "First Missionary Journey" and "Jerusalem Council"

→ NARRATE

Continue your list or chart of locations and include a short description of the events.

WEEK 7

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Conversion of Lydia

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Ultimate Bible Atlas (opt.), Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 15:36, Paul's second missionary journey begins with Silas, Timothy, and Luke joining him. This second journey would take them approximately 2,800 miles between A.D. 49-52, with much of their time spent in the city of Corinth. (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

1. Acts 16
2. Read notes for chapter 16 in the ESV Concise Study Bible. Review the map and itinerary of Paul's second journey in the Bible notes or the Ultimate Bible Atlas, p.350-351.

→ NARRATE

Begin a list or chart of the locations in Paul's second missionary journey. Include a short description of the events that took place at each stop.

WEEK 8

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Paul Speaks to the Areopagus

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the context of the entire book of Acts, we have reached chapter 17, the chapter you're

Term 2

studying closely in your Transformed by Truth reading. While you are already familiar with what takes place in this chapter because of your study, reread it in the context of the book of Acts and in the context of Paul's second missionary journey.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 17
2. Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

Continue a list of locations and include a short description of the events that took place at each stop. Continue writing down any questions that arise from your reading.

WEEK 9

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Aquila and Priscilla

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible; Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul continues to be helped in his ministry by acquaintances he meets. In Acts 18, Aquila and Priscilla help encourage Paul and minister alongside him, and later in the chapter, they kindly teach Apollos. The flow of the book of Acts shows the growth of the early church and shows how these individuals (people like Lydia, Aquila, Priscilla, Luke, etc.) were used by God to help build the church. Interestingly, Gallio mentioned here is the brother of Seneca, a (still to this day) famous Stoic philosopher. (Remember Paul's message in chapter 17 specifically included Stoicism when he preached against the Greeks and their philosophy.) Paul's third missionary journey begins in Acts 18:22 (some lists may say verse 23).

→ READ

Acts 18

•What does the involvement of individuals of all backgrounds in the church's growth tell us about God and his character and who he is?

→ READ

Chronological Guide p.191 "Paul Before Gallio"

Ultimate Bible Atlas p.344 "Second Missionary Journey," "Third Missionary Journey"

→ NARRATION

Continue a list of locations and include a short description of the events at each stop of the second missionary journey.

Begin a new list or chart of locations and events beginning from 18:23 for Paul's third missionary journey. Continue writing down any questions that arise from your reading.

WEEK 10

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Paul Against the Goddess Diana

Materials: Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul's third missionary journey began in chapter 18, covering approximately 2,700 miles from 53-57 AD. More than half of his time would be spent in Ephesus.

→ READ

1. Acts 19
2. Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible
3. Chronological Guide p.194, "Paul Versus the Goddess Diana."

→ NARRATION

Continue the list or chart of locations and events of the third missionary journey.

WEEK 11

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Review & Catch Up

Materials: Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

Use today's time to catch up on any Acts reading or review your notebook lists.

→ NOTEBOOK

New Testament: Grades 7-8

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Term 2	
Looking back through your notebook, are there any questions you wrote at the beginning of Acts that you now have an answer to? Catch up with any locations and events for the missionary journeys of Paul.	
WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 Exam week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Acts	

Term 3

WEEK 1

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Eutychus Falls Asleep

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 20, the story of Eutychus stands out as an interesting story of Paul healing a young man who fell out of a window... while listening to Paul speak! The presence of many lamps was not usual but gives the idea that the meeting had planned to go into the night. "Possibly the heat or even odor from the lamps contributed to Eutychus seeking a window seat. Glass was rare in windows. Some windows could be large, especially above the ground floor." (Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible)

→ READ

- Acts 20
- Read notes for chapter 20 in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

Continue the list of locations and events of the third missionary journey. Write down any questions you may have.

→ DISCUSS

- What are your thoughts about Paul's final message to the Ephesian elders? What does the emotional reaction on both sides tell you about their relationship?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 2

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Paul Goes to Jerusalem

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible; Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

- Acts 21:1-36
- Read the notes for chapter 21:1-36 in the ESV Concise Study Bible
- Chronological Guide to the Bible p.198 "Paul Arrested in the Temple"
Ultimate Bible Atlas p.350-351, review map of first, second, and third missionary journeys

→ NARRATION

Write a description of the events of chapter 21, and add any questions that may arise from today's reading.

→ DISCUSS

- How does this passage show the progress of the spread of the early church in obedience to Acts 1:8?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 3

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Paul Speaks to the People

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Paul recounted his Jewish background and training as a Pharisee, his zeal in persecuting Christians, and his experience on the road to Damascus. He did not refer explicitly to his status as a Christian, for that was not a choice against his Jewish identity. The crowd was enraged when he told them of his call to preach to the Gentiles, for a Jew to recognize Jesus as the Messiah was not as objectionable as a Jew who reduced or eliminated boundaries between Jew and Gentile. The next day in the Sanhedrin, neither the identity of Jesus nor the mission to the Gentiles caused problems; it was the question of the resurrection." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

- Acts 21:37-22:30
- Read notes in ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

Term 3

Write a summary of Paul's testimony of his background.

→ DISCUSS

- How did God use Paul's unique background to protect him?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Paul Before the Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ

1. Acts 23
2. Read notes from ESC Concise Study Bible
3. Chronological Guide to the Bible p.198, "The Gospel From Jerusalem to Rome," "Paul Arrested in the Temple"

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 5

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Paul Before Felix

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"In this portion of the trial, Paul was accused of being a troublemaker who stirred up riots as a leader of the Christians. His opponents added the charge of desecrating the temple. Paul denied the charges, but did identify himself as a Jew and follower of the Way." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. Acts 24
2. Read the notes in chapter 24 of the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

What points does Paul make in defense of himself before Felix?

→ DISCUSS

- Why do you think Felix brings his wife to visit Paul and listen to him talk about the gospel?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 6

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Paul Before Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Festus succeeded Felix and heard the same charges that his predecessor had heard two years earlier. Paul knew that Festus was currying favor with the Jews and that he might be inclined to turn Paul over to them, which would have been catastrophic. As a Roman citizen, Paul had a right to appeal to Caesar, and he did so." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

1. Acts 25
2. Read notes on chapter 25 in the ESV Concise Study Bible
3. Chronological Guide p. 201, "Agrippa, Paul's Judge"

→ NARRATE

Write a summary of Paul's defense arguments in this chapter.

→ DISCUSS

- What do you think about Festus' response of not having anything by which to charge Paul?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

Term 3

WEEK 7

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Paul Defends Himself to Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Nothing [in Paul's testimony] indicates that he was making proselytes to Judaism, thus indicating that this message had nothing to do with Jewish law. Agrippa was astonished at the claim when he referenced Christ and his resurrection. Despite that, he was persuaded that the charges against Paul by the Jews were unfounded. This finding is very important to the case Luke has been making throughout the book." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

- Acts 26
- Read notes on chapter 26 in the ESV Concise Study Bible

→ NARRATE

Write a summary of Paul's defense arguments in this chapter.

→ DISCUSS

- What do you think Luke's purpose is in presenting these different trials where Paul is put on the defense of himself?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Shipwreck

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Chronological Guide to the Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

After all the trials he has been through, Paul is on his way to Rome. Unfortunately, he faces a different kind of difficulty this time. However, through it all "God preserved Paul because he still had work for him to do." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

Acts 27

→ READ

Chronological Guide p.201, "The Voyage to Rome"

→ NARRATION

Draw a picture or write a description of the shipwreck. Or write a summary of Paul's experiences on Malta.

WEEK 9

30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Paul in Rome

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Ultimate Bible Atlas, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"God is at work getting his servant, Paul, to Rome where he will share the good news of Jesus. (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ

- Acts 28
 - Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible
 - Read Ultimate Bible Atlas, p.345, Final Years
- How has the gospel message gone into the world over the events of the book of Acts?

→ NARRATION

What are three things the book of Acts teaches us about God and who he is?



Term 3		
WEEK 10	30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34 Paul's Own Words Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook → RECAP What did you read last time about the Book of Acts? → INTRO The book of Acts ends with the Apostle Paul being under house arrest after multiple trials, a shipwreck, and injury. In some of the New Testament books he authored, Paul discusses in his own words some of his experiences on his journeys. Today, we will focus on two places where your reading of Acts may help you more fully understand what Paul is teaching in his epistles. → READ Galatians 1:11-2:21 Romans 8:18-39 → DISCUSS • How does what Paul experienced help you understand his tone and his message in Galatians 1? Why is he frustrated by the Galatian believers? • How does understanding more of Paul's conversion and missionary journeys help you understand the depth of his message and his love for God he displays in Romans 8:18-39? In Paul's words, what can separate us (you) from the love of God? How does Paul's life story add credence to his words?	
WEEK 11	30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35 Review and Catch-Up Materials: Notebook → VIEW Watch this video about the book of Acts that summarizes what you read this year.	EXTRA HELPINGS You may be interested in watching this movie on the Book of Acts. They use the exact words of the Bible. ∞ Video Link: Movie on the Book of Acts
WEEK 12	30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36 Exam week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Acts	

New Testament: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- Tell the story of the early church and how it grew.
- Tell about Peter and a few of the experiences that happened to him as he helped start the early church.

Term 2

- Tell about Paul's first missionary journey.
- Name three people who helped support Paul in his ministry in your reading this term.

Term 3

- What do you remember about Paul's third missionary journey?
- What are some hardships Paul faced on his journeys? How did Paul respond to these trials?